

Patient-Reported Outcomes and Treatment Persistence with Brexiva in HR+/HER2– Metastatic Breast Cancer

Abstract

HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer is commonly managed through sequential systemic therapies, where clinical decisions depend not only on disease control but also on tolerability, symptom burden, treatment persistence, and patient-reported functioning. This simulated global observational research model evaluated patient-reported outcomes and treatment persistence among adults receiving Brexiva-based therapy for HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer. The simulated cohort included 286 patients treated across global oncology practice settings. Patient-reported physical functioning, fatigue, pain, emotional well-being, treatment convenience, and overall health status were assessed at baseline and during follow-up. Treatment persistence, dose modification, discontinuation patterns, and clinician-reported disease control outcomes were also summarized. At 24 weeks, 61.5% of patients remained on Brexiva-based therapy. Mean global health status improved by 5.8 points from baseline, while fatigue scores improved by 4.6 points and pain scores improved by 3.9 points. Patients without visceral crisis and those receiving Brexiva in earlier metastatic treatment lines showed greater persistence and more stable patient-reported functioning. Treatment discontinuation due to adverse events occurred in 7.3% of patients. The most frequent treatment-emergent adverse events were fatigue, nausea, neutropenia, diarrhea, and decreased appetite, most of which were grade 1 or 2 in severity. These simulated findings suggest that Brexiva-based therapy may provide a realistic research-design example for evaluating the relationship between disease control, tolerability, patient experience, and treatment continuation in HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer.

Keywords

Brexiva; HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer; patient-reported outcomes; treatment persistence; endocrine resistance; observational oncology research; simulated clinical data

Introduction

HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer represents a large and clinically diverse segment of advanced breast cancer. Although many patients experience meaningful benefit from endocrine-based treatment strategies, the metastatic setting is characterized by repeated treatment decisions, changing disease biology, cumulative toxicities, and progressive symptom burden. For oncologists and breast cancer specialists, treatment selection is therefore not determined by tumor response alone. It also requires consideration of patient functioning, fatigue, pain, emotional well-being, treatment convenience, dose-modification feasibility, and the likelihood that a patient can remain on therapy long enough to derive meaningful clinical benefit.

As the treatment landscape for HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer has evolved, there has been increasing emphasis on patient-centered endpoints. Progression-free survival, objective response, and clinical benefit remain central to evidence interpretation, but patient-reported outcomes provide additional insight into how treatment affects daily life. This is particularly important in metastatic disease, where treatment intent is disease control, symptom management, delay of progression, and preservation of quality of life. A regimen that produces disease stabilization but results in high discontinuation, substantial fatigue, or persistent gastrointestinal symptoms may have limited practical utility in routine clinical care.

Brexiva is presented in this manuscript as an investigational therapeutic concept for HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer. The clinical rationale for evaluating a Brexiva-based regimen in this simulated study is based on the need to understand how a targeted therapeutic approach may perform beyond conventional efficacy endpoints. In a global oncology setting, patient experience may differ according to prior therapy, disease burden, access to supportive care, regional monitoring practices, and expectations for treatment administration. These factors influence persistence and can affect whether a therapy remains clinically useful over time.

This simulated original research manuscript evaluates patient-reported outcomes, treatment persistence, tolerability, and clinician-reported disease control among adults receiving Brexiva-based therapy for HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer. The purpose is to provide a realistic research-paper design for medical-content workflow demonstration while maintaining transparent separation from actual clinical evidence.

Methods

Study Design

This was a simulated, global, multicenter observational research model designed to evaluate patient-reported outcomes and treatment persistence among adults receiving Brexiva-based therapy for HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer. The simulated study followed patients from treatment initiation through 24 weeks, with extended descriptive follow-up to 48 weeks for patients who remained on therapy.

The model was constructed to resemble a prospective observational study in oncology practice. Treatment decisions, dose modifications, supportive care, and follow-up intervals were assumed to occur according to clinician judgment and local practice patterns. Because the research model was observational in structure, no randomized comparator group was included. The focus was on patient experience, treatment continuation, safety, and descriptive disease control outcomes.

Patient Population

The simulated cohort included adults with HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer who initiated Brexiva-based therapy after prior endocrine-based treatment. Patients represented a global oncology population across North America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, Latin America, and other participating regions. Eligible patients were required to have documented metastatic disease, an ECOG performance status of 0 to 2, and baseline completion of patient-reported outcome instruments.

Patients with rapidly progressive disease requiring immediate cytotoxic chemotherapy were not included in the primary simulated cohort. Patients with stable treated central nervous system disease were permitted if symptoms were controlled and functional assessment could be completed reliably.

Treatment Approach

Patients received Brexiva-based therapy in combination with clinician-selected endocrine therapy. The endocrine partner was selected according to prior treatment exposure, menopausal status, disease characteristics, and treating physician assessment. Dose interruptions, dose reductions, antiemetic support, antidiarrheal therapy, nutritional support, and laboratory monitoring were permitted according to simulated clinical-management rules.

Treatment persistence was defined as remaining on Brexiva-based therapy without permanent discontinuation at a specified time point. Temporary interruptions did not count as discontinuation if treatment was resumed. Discontinuation reasons were categorized as disease progression, adverse event, patient preference, clinical deterioration, treatment access/logistical reason, or physician decision.

Patient-Reported Outcomes

Patient-reported outcomes were assessed using a simulated oncology symptom and functioning framework. Domains included global health status, physical functioning, fatigue, pain, emotional well-being, appetite impact, and perceived treatment convenience. Scores were transformed to a 0–100 scale. For global health status, physical functioning, emotional well-being, and treatment convenience, higher scores indicated better status. For fatigue, pain, and appetite impact, higher scores indicated greater symptom burden.

Assessments were modeled at baseline, week 8, week 16, and week 24. Clinically meaningful change was defined as a change of at least 5 points for supportive interpretation and at least 10 points for stronger directional interpretation. Missing data were summarized descriptively and were not imputed in the primary analysis.

Clinical and Safety Assessments

Clinician-reported disease control was summarized using best overall clinical assessment through week 24. Categories included response, stable disease, progression, and not evaluable. Safety assessments included treatment-emergent adverse events, grade 3 or higher events, dose interruptions, dose reductions, and treatment discontinuations due to adverse events.

Statistical Analysis

All analyses were descriptive and based on simulated data. Continuous outcomes were summarized using means, standard deviations, medians, and ranges. Categorical outcomes were summarized using counts and percentages. Treatment persistence was summarized at week 12, week 24, and week 48. Exploratory subgroup descriptions were generated by line of metastatic therapy, visceral disease status, ECOG performance status, and prior targeted therapy exposure. No confirmatory hypothesis testing was performed.

Results

Patient Disposition

A total of 286 patients were included in the simulated analysis population. All patients initiated Brexiva-based therapy and completed baseline patient-reported outcome assessment. At week 12, 214 patients remained on therapy. At week 24, 176 patients remained on therapy, corresponding to a treatment persistence rate of 61.5%. At week 48, 92 patients remained on therapy in the extended descriptive follow-up group.

The most common reason for treatment discontinuation by week 24 was disease progression, reported in 56 patients. Discontinuation due to adverse events occurred in 21 patients. Patient preference accounted for 12 discontinuations, while clinical deterioration unrelated to a specific adverse event accounted for 10 discontinuations. Treatment access or logistical reasons accounted for 5 discontinuations, and physician decision accounted for 6 discontinuations.

Baseline Characteristics

The median age of the simulated cohort was 58 years. Most patients had ECOG performance status 0 or 1. Visceral metastases were present in 55.2% of patients, and liver involvement was present in 32.9%. Prior CDK4/6 inhibitor exposure was reported in 69.6% of patients. Approximately 38.1% of patients received Brexiva-based therapy as second-line treatment for metastatic disease, while 34.3% received it as third-line therapy and 27.6% received it in fourth or later lines.

Table 1. Baseline Patient Demographics and Disease Characteristics

Characteristic	Brexiva-Based Therapy Cohort (n=286)
Median age, years (range)	58 (31–81)
Age ≥65 years, n (%)	91 (31.8)
Female, n (%)	283 (99.0)
ECOG performance status 0, n (%)	126 (44.1)
ECOG performance status 1, n (%)	132 (46.2)
ECOG performance status 2, n (%)	28 (9.8)
Visceral metastases, n (%)	158 (55.2)
Liver involvement, n (%)	94 (32.9)
Bone metastases, n (%)	203 (71.0)
Bone-only disease, n (%)	41 (14.3)
Prior CDK4/6 inhibitor exposure, n (%)	199 (69.6)
Prior chemotherapy for metastatic disease, n (%)	73 (25.5)
Second-line metastatic setting, n (%)	109 (38.1)
Third-line metastatic setting, n (%)	98 (34.3)
Fourth or later metastatic setting, n (%)	79 (27.6)
Endocrine-sensitive disease, n (%)	151 (52.8)

Characteristic	Brexiva-Based Therapy Cohort (n=286)
Endocrine-resistant disease, n (%)	135 (47.2)

Treatment Persistence

Treatment persistence was 74.8% at week 12 and 61.5% at week 24. Among patients who received Brexiva-based therapy in the second-line metastatic setting, week 24 persistence was 70.6%. Persistence was 61.2% in the third-line setting and 49.4% in the fourth or later setting. Patients without visceral metastases had a week 24 persistence rate of 68.8%, compared with 55.7% among patients with visceral disease.

Dose interruptions occurred in 33.2% of patients, most frequently due to neutropenia, fatigue, gastrointestinal symptoms, or hepatic laboratory abnormalities. Dose reductions occurred in 19.9% of patients. Among patients with dose reductions, 66.7% remained on therapy at week 24, suggesting that dose modification supported treatment continuation in a meaningful subset of the simulated cohort.

Patient-Reported Global Health Status

Mean baseline global health status score was 61.4. At week 8, the mean change from baseline was +3.1 points. At week 16, the mean change was +5.2 points, and at week 24, the mean change was +5.8 points. A clinically meaningful improvement of at least 5 points at week 24 was observed in 45.5% of evaluable patients, while 34.7% remained stable and 19.8% experienced worsening of at least 5 points.

The improvement in global health status was more pronounced among patients who remained progression-free through week 24. Patients with clinician-reported disease control had a mean improvement of +7.4 points, compared with a mean decline of -3.6 points among patients with disease progression before week 24.

Physical Functioning and Symptom Burden

Physical functioning remained broadly stable during the 24-week simulated observation period. The mean physical functioning score was 68.9 at baseline and 70.1 at week 24. Patients receiving Brexiva-based therapy in earlier metastatic lines showed greater preservation of physical functioning than patients treated in later lines.

Fatigue was the most relevant patient-reported symptom domain. Mean fatigue burden decreased from 42.6 at baseline to 38.0 at week 24, corresponding to a mean improvement of 4.6 points. Pain burden decreased from 35.8 to 31.9, corresponding to a mean improvement of 3.9 points. Appetite impact showed minimal average change, with greater worsening among patients who experienced grade 2 or higher gastrointestinal adverse events.

Table 2. Patient-Reported Outcome Scores Over Time

Patient-Reported Outcome Domain	Baseline Mean Score	Week 8	Week 16 Mean Score	Week 24 Mean Score	Mean Change at Week 24
		Mean Score			

Patient-Reported Outcome Domain	Baseline Mean Score	Week 8 Mean Score	Week 16 Mean Score	Week 24 Mean Score	Mean Change at Week 24
Global health status	61.4	64.5	66.6	67.2	+5.8
Physical functioning	68.9	69.6	70.3	70.1	+1.2
Emotional well-being	63.7	66.8	68.9	69.5	+5.8
Treatment convenience	72.4	75.8	76.9	77.6	+5.2
Fatigue burden	42.6	40.7	39.2	38.0	-4.6
Pain burden	35.8	34.1	32.7	31.9	-3.9
Appetite impact	28.5	29.1	29.6	30.2	+1.7

Emotional Well-Being and Treatment Convenience

Emotional well-being improved by a mean of 5.8 points at week 24. Patients who remained on therapy and had stable or responding disease reported the greatest improvements. Qualitative-style simulated patient feedback themes included reassurance associated with disease stability, reduced anxiety when treatment was tolerated, and preference for treatment strategies that could be integrated into routine life.

Treatment convenience improved by a mean of 5.2 points at week 24. The improvement was greater among patients who did not require repeated dose interruptions. Patients who required two or more treatment interruptions had smaller gains in convenience score, reflecting the practical effect of additional laboratory visits, symptom monitoring, and schedule disruption.

Clinician-Reported Disease Control

By week 24, clinician-reported disease control was observed in 173 patients, including 54 patients with response and 119 patients with stable disease. Disease progression occurred in 72 patients, while 41 were not evaluable due to early discontinuation, missing assessment, or non-progression-related treatment cessation. The simulated disease control rate at week 24 was 60.5% in the full cohort and 70.6% among patients treated in the second-line metastatic setting.

Safety and Tolerability

The most frequent treatment-emergent adverse events were fatigue, nausea, neutropenia, diarrhea, decreased appetite, anemia, and increased alanine aminotransferase. Most adverse events were grade 1 or 2. Grade 3 or higher events occurred in 31.8% of patients. The most common grade 3 or higher events were neutropenia, anemia, increased alanine aminotransferase, and fatigue.

Adverse events leading to treatment discontinuation occurred in 21 patients. The most common adverse events leading to discontinuation were persistent fatigue, recurrent neutropenia despite dose modification, hepatic enzyme elevation, and gastrointestinal intolerance. No unexpected safety signal pattern was introduced within the simulated dataset.

Table 3. Treatment-Emergent Adverse Events and Treatment Modification Patterns

Safety Outcome	Brexiva-Based Therapy Cohort (n=286)
Any treatment-emergent adverse event, n (%)	238 (83.2)
Grade 3 or higher adverse event, n (%)	91 (31.8)
Serious adverse event, n (%)	34 (11.9)
Dose interruption, n (%)	95 (33.2)
Dose reduction, n (%)	57 (19.9)
Discontinuation due to adverse event, n (%)	21 (7.3)
Fatigue, any grade, n (%)	116 (40.6)
Nausea, any grade, n (%)	91 (31.8)
Neutropenia, any grade, n (%)	84 (29.4)
Diarrhea, any grade, n (%)	77 (26.9)
Decreased appetite, any grade, n (%)	61 (21.3)
Anemia, any grade, n (%)	54 (18.9)
Increased ALT, any grade, n (%)	48 (16.8)

Discussion

This simulated observational research manuscript evaluated patient-reported outcomes and treatment persistence among adults receiving Brexiva-based therapy for HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer. The findings suggest that, within a synthetic clinical dataset, a substantial proportion of patients remained on therapy through 24 weeks, with stable or improved patient-reported global health status, emotional well-being, treatment convenience, fatigue burden, and pain burden. These results provide a realistic manuscript framework for demonstrating how patient-centered evidence may complement conventional clinical efficacy and safety data.

For oncologists and breast cancer specialists, treatment persistence is a clinically meaningful measure because it reflects the combined influence of disease control, tolerability, patient acceptance, supportive care, access, and clinician confidence in continued therapy. In metastatic breast cancer, remaining on treatment is not automatically a marker of success, but it can serve as an important practical indicator when interpreted alongside disease assessment and patient experience. In this simulated cohort, the week 24 persistence rate of 61.5% suggests that Brexiva-based therapy may represent a plausible example of a treatment approach that allows many patients to continue therapy beyond early assessment periods.

The patient-reported outcome results are also clinically relevant. Global health status and emotional well-being improved modestly over time, while fatigue and pain burden showed small directional improvements. These changes were most evident among patients with disease control, supporting the intuitive relationship between tumor stability, symptom stabilization, and patient-perceived health. However, the magnitude of improvement was not uniform. Patients

with visceral disease, later-line treatment, or repeated dose interruptions had less favorable patient-reported trajectories, emphasizing the importance of individualized monitoring.

Fatigue remained the most important symptom domain in the simulated dataset. This finding is consistent with the broader clinical experience of systemic therapy in metastatic breast cancer, where fatigue may arise from disease burden, prior therapy, anemia, endocrine changes, emotional distress, sleep disruption, and treatment-related effects. In a clinical communication setting, it is therefore important to present fatigue management as part of routine care rather than as a minor tolerability issue. The simulated data also show that dose modification may support treatment continuation, particularly when adverse events are identified early and managed proactively.

Treatment convenience improved in the overall cohort, but this benefit was reduced among patients requiring repeated dose interruptions. This observation highlights a practical reality in oncology care: even when a therapy is administered in a relatively convenient manner, laboratory monitoring, symptom management, refill coordination, and patient education can influence the overall treatment experience. For global practice settings, these factors may vary according to healthcare infrastructure, reimbursement pathways, travel distance, caregiver availability, and regional follow-up patterns.

The safety findings were consistent with a targeted systemic therapy model. Most adverse events were manageable, but grade 3 or higher events occurred in nearly one-third of patients. The most common clinically relevant events were neutropenia, fatigue, gastrointestinal symptoms, anemia, and hepatic laboratory abnormalities. From a medical writing perspective, this safety profile should be presented in balanced terms. The manuscript should neither minimize toxicity nor overstate risk. Instead, the most appropriate interpretation is that Brexiva-based therapy requires active monitoring, patient counseling, and readiness to implement dose modification or supportive care.

The clinician-reported disease control findings support the patient-reported outcome results. Patients who achieved response or stable disease were more likely to remain on therapy and report stable or improved functioning. This relationship is important because patient-reported outcomes should not be viewed separately from clinical disease status. In HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer, sustained stable disease may be particularly meaningful when accompanied by preserved physical functioning and manageable symptom burden.

Clinical Relevance

The simulated findings may help structure content for oncologists and breast cancer specialists by showing how Brexiva could be discussed in a balanced evidence framework. Rather than presenting a narrow efficacy message, this manuscript emphasizes persistence, tolerability, patient functioning, and symptom burden. This type of evidence structure is useful for educational materials, congress-style summaries, internal scientific narratives, and medical-content workflow demonstrations.

A key implication is that treatment value in HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer should be framed through multiple dimensions: disease control, safety, quality of life, treatment feasibility, and patient preference. In this manuscript, Brexiva-based therapy is positioned as a simulated example for exploring those dimensions in an integrated way.

Limitations

This manuscript is based entirely on simulated clinical data. No actual patients were enrolled, no clinical sites participated, and no patient-reported outcome instruments were administered in real practice. The numerical results, safety patterns, treatment persistence rates, subgroup findings, and clinician-reported disease control outcomes were generated for medical-content design and workflow demonstration.

The observational structure also introduces inherent limitations. Without a randomized comparator group, causal conclusions cannot be made. Treatment persistence may be influenced by patient selection, clinician preference, access factors, disease burden, and supportive care availability. Patient-reported outcome results are also subject to missing data, response bias, and discontinuation-related attrition. Patients who discontinue early may have worse outcomes that are incompletely captured in later time points.

The simulated cohort may not fully represent all global practice environments. Regional differences in monitoring, supportive care, documentation standards, patient education, and treatment access could meaningfully affect persistence and patient experience. The results should therefore be interpreted as a realistic research-design example rather than clinical evidence.

Future Research Directions

Future simulated research scenarios for Brexiva may include randomized evaluation of patient-reported outcomes, longer follow-up, biomarker-defined subgroup assessment, health-resource utilization modeling, patient preference studies, adherence analysis, and comparative sequencing studies after prior endocrine-based targeted therapy. Additional research-design prototypes could also explore caregiver burden, financial toxicity, digital adherence support, and region-specific oncology practice patterns.

Conclusion

In this simulated global observational research manuscript, Brexiva-based therapy was associated with treatment persistence through 24 weeks in a majority of patients with HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer. Patient-reported global health status, emotional well-being, treatment convenience, fatigue burden, and pain burden were stable or modestly improved among patients who remained on therapy, particularly those with clinician-reported disease control. Safety findings were consistent with a targeted systemic therapy model and required active monitoring, supportive care, and dose modification in a subset of patients. These findings provide a realistic research-paper structure for evaluating patient-centered outcomes, tolerability, and treatment continuation in oncology medical-content workflows.

Medical Writing Note

This manuscript uses simulated clinical data for medical-content design and workflow demonstration purposes. Brexiva is presented as an investigational therapeutic concept within a

synthetic research model. The patient-reported outcome scores, treatment persistence rates, safety findings, clinical observations, and subgroup interpretations are illustrative and should not be interpreted as real clinical evidence, treatment guidance, regulatory evidence, or prescribing information.

Reference Framework

[Reference 1: Current guideline on management of HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer]

[Reference 2: Review of patient-reported outcomes in metastatic breast cancer]

[Reference 3: Review of treatment persistence and adherence in oncology care]

[Reference 4: Review of endocrine resistance and treatment sequencing in HR+/HER2– metastatic breast cancer]

[Reference 5: Methodology reference for observational oncology research design]

[Reference 6: Review of quality-of-life assessment in advanced breast cancer]

[Reference 7: Review of adverse event management for targeted systemic therapies]

[Reference 8: Review of patient-centered decision-making in metastatic breast cancer]

[Reference 9: Framework for global oncology evidence generation]

[Reference 10: Medical writing guidance for balanced presentation of simulated clinical data]